

But let's just talk about gaming for a second... there are 300 million gamers in India already. Still, only a single-digit percentage of gamers is on PCs. However, if you look at the way gaming is moving—as a country we're getting into e-sports and gaming competitions—we are using gaming as a way to generate income. Automatically you move towards the PC when you think about gaming in those ways.

If you look at the trends, there is nothing that indicates that the need for the PC is not going to continue to grow. There will be ups and downs and there will also be periods where segments don't necessarily [grow].

Q: HP now sells refurbished laptops in India. How successful has this been?

A: India was the first place where we launched it, and it's been very successful for us. It stems from two philosophies or two values that we have, [and] that I hold very dearly and are part of the reasons why I joined

Q: Can you share some numbers? Would the manufacturing be focussed on India consumption or are you planning to export from India?

A: Right now, I can't share any numbers, but the goal is to focus on India consumption.

Q: Beyond hardware, what are the primary focus areas for HP going forward?

A: For us, it's the ability to take our products, our solutions, and our services to people to learn better. So, focus on education, [and] help SMBs and entrepreneurs be more efficient and productive in the way that they run their businesses, and in the way that they expand. And on the way enterprise and government are able to be at the leading edge of technology to drive growth.

Some of that involves thinking about services that we can provide that will help. Some of it is about

“Four days after I joined, the global board of HP arrived in India to have their first-ever board meeting outside of the US; the entire board spent five days here just absorbing and understanding the potential of this market”

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HP. The first one is the idea of sustainability, and the importance of us creating an environment and earth that we want to leave intact to the next generations. So, nothing better than a refurbishment programme to drive that circularity and that sustainability. The second one is the idea of increasing accessibility and affordability—being able to get PCs in the hands of more women, more freelancers, more first-time PC users.

Q: HP manufactures select stock-keeping units (SKUs) of desktops and Chromebooks in India and is participating in PLI 2.0. Could you shed some light on your manufacturing plans?

A: We are very excited about the fact that government is taking the initiative to do something like a PLI scheme across sectors and the sort of development of the manufacturing industry in India. The growth in manufacturing across sectors and the growth of job opportunities is fantastic to see. We applied for and got approval for PLI last year. So, it's very much part of our plans to expand our manufacturing to do more in India through the PLI scheme.

the actual product that we deliver. But more than thinking about it from a hardware-plus perspective, we're thinking about it from a customer use-case perspective, to say what are the best ways in which what we make will be valuable in helping drive some of these things. [We want to] drive education in our country to a level where very talented people—we have 2.2 million STEM graduates that come out of India a year—[have access to computers].

Their access to technology is not strong enough if we have a sub-20% penetration of PCs. We can't have computer science graduates who haven't spent more than two hours a week on a computer. So, the ability to be able to [help] genuine use cases and the ability to run both pilots and eventually business models that create that accessibility and affordability is the way I think we're thinking about it more. Which is, how do we place these products—our printers or PC—and then the services that surround those into these areas of activation in the country. **BT**

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